

New Testament





About the Course

Each year in High School, students read one of the gospels along with several other New Testament epistles. For 2026-2027, they read the gospel of Luke along with Galatians, Philippians, and Colossians. Using their study Bibles and other resources, students encounter scripture and seek to understand the cultural, historical, and theological context of their readings in order to more deeply appreciate the richness of the Bible and the humility needed in order to live out God's word today.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Bible: Grade 9



Placement & Combining Tips

Appropriate for any HS grades. Students new to reading the Bible for themselves or unused to commentaries or study notes may find the lessons in Grades 7-8 a gentler introduction to these study practices.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
9	New Testament: Grade 9 1 time/week 30 min	NIV Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible: Bringing to Life the Ancient World of Scripture Introducing the New Testament: A Historical, Literary, and Theological Survey Luke for Everyone

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Bible: Grade 9				
Bible History: Grade 9	Old Testament: Grades 7-12	New Testament: Grade 9	Old Testament: Grades 7-12	Church History: Grades 7-9



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

New Testament: Grade 9



NIV Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible: Bringing to Life the Ancient World of Scripture



Introducing the New Testament: A Historical, Literary, and Theological Survey



Luke for Everyone



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Related Course Quick Links

∞ [Foundations \(See Section 6: Bible\)](#)

Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.



New Testament: Grade 9

How To Approach



Recap

Take a moment to recall what you read previously in the same book or topic.



Read

Read the passage assigned or read for the number of minutes allocated. If a book is challenging for you, try stopping to narrate to yourself silently now and then to make sure you are tracking. Or you could listen to an audiobook version of the text and read along. You may also want to read aloud to yourself. If a book is an easy read, enjoy the ride! Keep an eye out for quotes to put in your Commonplace Book or events or characters to put down in your Book of Centuries.



Narrate

Process and integrate your reading by narrating either orally or in writing. Some lesson plans will give you a suggestion of how best to narrate. You might want to set a timer to keep yourself on track, so you stop reading with enough time to narrate.



Connect

Read notes in your Study Bible or commentary. Look up places mentioned in the text in your Bible atlas. Add something to your Book of Centuries or Commonplace Book. Jot down additional reflections and thoughts in your Bible notebook or share with others.



Teacher Note

Read over the lesson plans to familiarize yourself with the content for accountability and interest. If doing the lessons together, use a picture, a map, or an engaging question to rouse students' interest before reading. You may also highlight one or two unfamiliar terms if needed. If in a classroom context, you may choose to leave larger doctrinal conversations for students to have with their parents at home.

New Testament: Grade 9

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Term 1

WEEK 1 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 1

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Introducing the New Testament, Luke for Everyone, notebook

→ INTRO

Each year in HS, we will be reading one of the Gospels along with our study of the rest of the New Testament books. This year, we will be reading Luke along with Galatians, Philippians, and Colossians. It is helpful to be continually reminded of who Jesus is and how he interacted with people. The Gospel accounts were designed to be read many times. There will be insights gained that you would only pick up after multiple readings and by paying attention to repeated words and themes.

We will make use of the Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible notes and maps, Introducing the New Testament (selections), a Luke commentary (selections), and some Bible Project videos to help us understand what Luke and Paul are saying to their audiences. Then we can think about what new thoughts about God we gain in the process. You do not need to read all the study notes for all the verses. Pick and choose based on which verses you have questions about. Use a digital or physical notebook to record your thoughts as you work your way through the readings.

→ VIEW & NARRATE

Today and over the next few weeks, we will set the stage for reading Luke and the Epistles by gaining some context. Narrate silently in your head or by talking to yourself to go over the main points. Write down a few of them in your journal.

∞ Video Link: How to Read the New Testament

→ READ & NARRATE

Introducing the New Testament
Ch.1 p.17-24

Make a list with a short description of the rulers in Palestine at the time of Jesus.

→ MAP WORK

When places are named in the text, refer to a map in the Study Bible or in the Introducing the NT book. Finding the places on the map is very helpful for seeing the stories in the context of the land. Sketching your own maps of journeys or regions can be helpful too.

★ NOTE

These two journal options with different designs contain only the Bible book text and space to write. You may find them a good choice for your studies this year, as you can underline, highlight, or make notes right on the page.

∞ Link: ESV Scripture Journal Luke

∞ Link: ESV Illuminated Scripture Journal Luke

WEEK 2 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 2

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Luke for Everyone, Introducing the NT

→ READ

Luke 1

→ NARRATE & RESPOND

Talk over to yourself what you just read. Then, respond to what you read by putting down a few of your thoughts or questions. Just as in nature study, when we ask questions such as, "What do I notice? What do I wonder? What does this remind me of?" we can ask the same questions about what we read.

→ READ

Pick one of the Luke for Everyone readings discussing verses from Luke 1. Jot down any new insights or thoughts.

→ READ

★ NOTE

Instead of reading Luke for some of the lessons, consider watching and listening to Luke via the LUMO Project, which only uses the actual text of Luke but has people acting while it is read. There are many versions and many languages available. You might consider this resource for your modern language studies, too. However, be sure to ask yourself, "What did the film add visually that the Gospel text itself did not explicitly say?" as any visualization project requires interpretive decisions to be made.

∞ Video Links:

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Term 1

Introducing the New Testament
Ch.1 p.31-32 "Social Systems" - "more than they needed."
Write a sentence summarizing the mindset of the NT world towards wealth and poverty.

Lumo Project Luke 1:1-38
Lumo Project Luke 1:39-80

WEEK 3 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 3

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Luke for Everyone, Introducing the NT

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ

Luke 2-3

→ NARRATE & RESPOND

Talk over to yourself what you just read. Then, respond to what you read by putting down a few of your thoughts or questions.

→ READ

Choose a reading from Luke 2-3 in Luke for Everyone to read. Write down any thoughts.

→ READ

Introducing the New Testament
Ch.1 p.32-33 "Patronage and Loyalty" - "to serve (faith)."
Write a sentence summarizing the mindset of the NT world towards patronage and loyalty.

★ NOTE

The Bible Project has an app with a weekly playlist to go deeper into many topics for continued study.

∞ Info Link: Bible Project App

WEEK 4 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 4

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Luke for Everyone, Introducing the NT

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Luke 4-5

→ READ

Choose a reading from Luke 4-5 in Luke for Everyone to read. Write down any thoughts.

→ READ

Introducing the New Testament
Ch.1 p.33-34 "Honor and Shame" - "of the cross (Heb. 12:2)."
Write a sentence summarizing the mindset of the NT world towards honor and shame.

WEEK 5 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 5

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Luke for Everyone, Introducing the NT

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Luke 6-7

→ READ

→ MAP WORK

Don't forget to find place names on your maps or sketch a map that shows where the events are taking place.

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Term 1

Choose a reading from Luke 6-7 in Luke for Everyone to read. Write down your thoughts.

→ READ

Introducing the New Testament

Ch.1 p.34-35 "Life under Roman Rule" - "to Roman gods (see box 26.6)."

Write a few sentences summarizing life under Roman Rule.

WEEK 6 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 6

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Luke for Everyone, Introducing the NT

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Luke 8-9

→ READ

Choose a reading from your chapters in Luke for Everyone to read. Jot down your thoughts, reflections, and observations.

→ READ

Introducing the New Testament

Ch.2 p.39-41 "The New Testament" - "Second Temple period- and beyond."

Write a few sentences summarizing "the story thus far."

★ NOTE

The Bible Project has an interesting video and podcast series on the parables if you are interested in learning more!

∞ **Video Link:** How to Read the Parables

∞ **Podcast Series Link:** Decoding the Parables

WEEK 7 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 7

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Luke for Everyone, Introducing the NT

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Luke 10-11

→ READ

Choose a reading from your chapters in Luke for Everyone to read. Jot down your thoughts, reflections, and observations.

→ READ

Introducing the New Testament

Ch.2 p.41-43 "The People of Palestine" - "missionary for Christ (see Phil. 3:5)."

Write a few sentences summarizing the Pharisees.

★ NOTE

Set up a time to discuss with a parent or teacher what you are learning.

WEEK 8 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 8

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Luke for Everyone, Introducing the NT

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Luke 12-13

→ READ

Don't forget to read any study notes in your Bible that you are curious

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Term 1

about. Choose a reading from Luke for Everyone to read. Jot down your thoughts, reflections, and observations.

→ READ

Introducing the New Testament

Ch.2 p.43-46 "Sadducees" - "some of their ideas."

Write a few sentences summarizing the Sadducees and the Essenes.

WEEK 9 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 9

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Luke for Everyone, Introducing the NT

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Luke 14-15

→ READ

Luke for Everyone

Jot down your thoughts, reflections, and observations.

→ READ

Introducing the New Testament

Ch.2 p.46-49 "Zealots" - "became Christians (Acts 8:5-17)."

Write a few sentences summarizing the Zealots, Herodians, and Samaritans.

WEEK 10 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 10

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Luke for Everyone, Introducing the NT

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Luke 16-17

→ READ & REFLECT

Luke for Everyone

→ READ

Introducing the New Testament

Ch.2 p.49-50 "Gentiles" - "(see Acts 10:1-2)."

Write a few sentences summarizing the Gentiles.

WEEK 11 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 11

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Luke for Everyone, Introducing the NT

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Luke 18-19

→ READ & REFLECT

Luke for Everyone

→ READ

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Term 1

Introducing the New Testament
Ch.3 p.59-61 "The NT Writings" - "longest to shortest)."
Write a few sentences about what was new to you from this reading.

WEEK 12 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:
Luke

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Term 2

WEEK 1 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 13

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Luke for Everyone, Introducing the NT

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Luke 20-21

→ READ & REFLECT

Luke for Everyone

→ READ

Introducing the New Testament
Ch.5 p.95-96 "The Gospels" - "and a fourth."
Write a few sentences about the Gospels.

WEEK 2 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 14

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Luke for Everyone, Introducing the NT

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Luke 22-23

→ READ & REFLECT

Luke for Everyone

→ READ

Introducing the New Testament
Ch.5 p.96-99 "Genre" - "Jesus or not."
Write a few sentences about the Gospels as ancient biographies.

WEEK 3 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 15

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Luke for Everyone, Introducing the NT

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Luke 24

→ READ & REFLECT

Luke for Everyone

→ READ

Introducing the New Testament
Ch.8 p.161, 163-166 "Historical Background" - "as the Gospel of Matthew"
Write a few sentences about the historical background of Luke.

★ NOTE

Set up a time to discuss with a parent, teacher, or classmate what you are learning.

WEEK 4 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 16

Bible Project

→ VIEW & NARRATE

∞ Video Link: How to Read the NT Letters in Historical Context

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Term 2

∞ Video Link: How to Read the NT Letters in Literary Context

→ WRITE

Jot down any notes that you want to remember as we begin the study of Galatians.

WEEK 5 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 17

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Introducing the NT

→ INTRO

Today, we will set the stage for reading Galatians by gaining some context for the book of Galatians.

→ READ

Introducing the NT
Ch.16 p.323

→ VIEW & WRITE

Bible Project
∞ Video Link: Intro to Galatians
Write down some of the main points that stuck out to you.

→ PRINT

You may want to print out the summary to reference as you read Galatians.
∞ Image Link: Galatians Summary Poster

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Galatians 1

WEEK 6 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 18

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Introducing the NT

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ

Introducing the New Testament
Ch.16 p.329-332 "Major Themes" - "church officials (see box 16.5)."
Write a few sentences about the Incident at Antioch.

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Galatians 2

★ NOTE

The Bible Project has an interesting podcast series on the Letters of the NT if you are interested in learning more!

∞ Podcast Series Link: Letters of the NT

WEEK 7 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 19

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Introducing the NT

→ READ

Introducing the New Testament
Ch.16 p.332 "Christ and the Law" - "on Romans."
Write a few sentences about Point One.

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Galatians 3

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Term 2

WEEK 8 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 20

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Introducing the NT

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ

Introducing the New Testament
Ch.16 p.333-334 "Point Two" - "Abraham is being fulfilled."
Write a few sentences about Point Two and Point Three.

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Galatians 4

WEEK 9 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 21

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Introducing the NT

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ

Introducing the New Testament
Ch.16 p.335-337 "Point Four" - "and philosophers."
Write a few sentences about Point Four and the Conclusion.

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Galatians 5

★ NOTE

Discuss with a parent, teacher, or classmate what you are learning.

WEEK 10 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 22

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Galatians 6

WEEK 11 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 23

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Introducing the NT

→ INTRO

Today, we will set the stage for reading Philippians by gaining some context specific to the book.

→ READ

Introducing the NT
Ch.18 p.357

→ VIEW

Bible Project
∞ Video Link: Intro to Philippians

→ PRINT

You may want to print out the summary of the book to reference as you read Philippians.
∞ Image Link: Philippians Summary Poster

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Term 2	
→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND Philippians 1:1-26	
WEEK 12  30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 24 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course.	

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Term 3

WEEK 1 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 25

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Introducing the NT

→ RECAP

What did you read at the end of Term 2?

→ READ & WRITE

Introducing the NT

Ch.18 p.359-360, 363-364

Write a few sentences about the historical background of Philippi, the Incarnation, and the Christ Hymn.

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Philippians 1:27-2:18

WEEK 2 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 26

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Introducing the NT

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ & WRITE

Introducing the NT

Ch.18 p.365

Write a few sentences about humility.

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Philippians 2:19-30

★ NOTE

Discuss with a parent, teacher, or classmate what you are learning.

WEEK 3 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 27

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Introducing the NT

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ & WRITE

Introducing the NT

Ch.18 p.366-367 top

Write a few sentences about suffering.

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Philippians 3:1-4:1

WEEK 4 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 28

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Introducing the NT

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ & WRITE

Introducing the NT

Ch.18 p.367-369

Write a few sentences about fellowship and hope.

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Term 3

→ **READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND**
Philippians 4:2-23

WEEK 5 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 29

📖 Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Introducing the NT

→ **INTRO**

Today, we will set the stage for reading Colossians by gaining some context specific to the book.

→ **VIEW**

Bible Project

∞ Video Link: Intro to Colossians

Write down some of the main ideas or themes.

→ **PRINT**

You may want to print out the summary of the book to reference as you read.

∞ Image Link: Colossians Summary Poster

→ **READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND**

Colossians 1:1-23

★ **NOTE**

Discuss with a parent, teacher, or classmate what you are learning.

WEEK 6 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 30

📖 Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Introducing the NT

→ **RECAP**

What did you read last time?

→ **READ & WRITE**

Introducing the NT

Ch.19 p.372-376 "Historical Background" - "against such a notion."

Write a few sentences about the historical background of Colossae and what the "Colossian Heresy" might have been.

→ **READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND**

Colossians 1:24-2:5

WEEK 7 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 31

📖 Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Introducing the NT

→ **RECAP**

What did you read last time?

→ **READ & WRITE**

Introducing the NT

Ch.19 p.378-379 "Major Themes" - "for anything else."

Write a few sentences about the theme of the cosmic Christ.

→ **READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND**

Colossians 2:6-23

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Term 3

WEEK 8 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 32

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Introducing the NT

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ & WRITE

Introducing the NT

Ch.19 p.380-381

Write a few sentences describing what "Realized Eschatology" is and what the point of it is. How does it help us?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Colossians 3

★ NOTE

Discuss with a parent, teacher, or classmate what you are learning.

WEEK 9 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 33

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Introducing the NT

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ & WRITE

Introducing the NT

Ch.19 p.382-383

Write a few sentences describing the theme of knowledge and maturity in Colossians.

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Colossians 4

WEEK 10 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 34

Materials: Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible, Introducing the NT

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ READ & WRITE

Introducing the NT

Ch.19 p.384-385

Write a few sentences on the topic of ecology.

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Read the book of Colossians straight through from beginning to end (or as much as you have time for), reflecting on what you have learned along the way.

WEEK 11 30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 35

Catch Up

→ CATCH UP

Use this week to catch up on any readings or listen to one of the podcasts at the Bible Project site.

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Term 3

WEEK 12  **30m New Testament: Grade 9 - Lesson 36**

Exam Week

→ **EXAMS**

Answer question(s) related to the course.

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Examination

Term 1

· **Luke:** Choose two and write a few paragraphs on each:

- a) Tell the story of the foretelling and birth of John the Baptist.
- b) Tell a few of the stories you read about when Jesus heals someone.
- c) Give an account of one of the parables of Jesus.
- d) Tell the story of one of the miracles of Jesus.

Then, write a paragraph telling about what was most significant to you in Luke.

Term 2

· **Galatians:** Choose one:

- a) Tell how Paul addresses the believers in Galatia regarding faith and law. What are some ways the Gospel was being undermined?
 - b) What is meant by "It is for freedom that Christ has set us free. Stand firm, then, and do not let yourselves be burdened again by a yoke of slavery" (Gal. 5:1).
 - c) Discuss Paul's claim to authority to explain the Gospel.
- Add any insights or new thoughts of God you have gained from Galatians.

Term 3

· **Philippians:** Discuss one of the themes of Incarnation, Humility, Suffering, or Fellowship. Add anything else you would like about insights you have gained from Philippians.

· **Colossians:** What does Paul have to say in his letter to the Colossians about "God's dear Son...in whom we have redemption" OR "new life in the risen Christ?" Add anything else you would like about insights you have gained from Colossians.